

Shawheen Azimi

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Senior Security Architect, Engineer, and Analyst with experience across cyber, cloud, and AI in high-assurance environments. Combines deep technical expertise with a business-minded, entrepreneurial approach to security.

Professional Experiences

General Atomics & Affiliated Companies

Senior Security Engineer & Architect | Oct 2025 – Present

Security Engineer – Detection & Response II | Mar 2024 – Oct 2025

Security Engineer – Detection & Response | Oct 2022 – Mar 2024

Cybersecurity Analyst | Nov 2021 – Oct 2022

- **Multi-Cloud Security Architecture & Governance:** Owned the design and build-out of enterprise Azure and AWS security programs across a NIST/CMMC-aligned multi-cloud environment, integrating cloud-native controls with on-prem security infrastructure to support regulated workloads at scale.
- **Enterprise Threat Detection & Incident Command:** Served as Tier-3 incident response authority for Advanced Persistent Threat (APT) activity across an enterprise of 20,000+ endpoints, leading containment, eradication, and executive-level risk assessment for nation-state and insider-threat events.
- **Detection Engineering Platform (CI/CD & Validation):** Architected and engineered a Detection-as-Code CI/CD platform, treating detections as software through Git-based version control, SIGMA rule conversion, automated efficacy testing, and adversary-driven validation pipelines.
- **CMMC Program Leadership & Audit Execution:** Led enterprise-wide preparation for CMMC compliance across all security control domains, driving control implementation, evidence development, and audit readiness while coordinating cross-functional stakeholders. Executed audit support and artifact validation for third-party assessment, directly enabling certification and protecting hundreds of millions of dollars in contract revenue.
- **Adversary Emulation & Defensive Validation:** Led full-scope adversary emulation campaigns modeling real-world APT tradecraft, using results to drive detection engineering, SOC coverage gaps, and defensive control improvements across endpoint, identity, cloud, and network layers.
- **Enterprise Digital Forensics & Insider Threat:** Directed forensic investigations involving insider threat, data misuse, and regulatory exposure, coordinating legal, HR, and security stakeholders while preserving evidentiary integrity and operational continuity.
- **AI-Powered Security Operations Architecture:** Built and integrated AI infrastructure into SecOps tooling, enabling an AI-augmented SOC capable of accelerated triage, enrichment, and investigative decision-making at scale.
- **Global SaaS Security Architecture:** Owned security architecture and engineering for a global SaaS platform serving multi-national customers, implementing secure-by-design cloud infrastructure, identity segmentation, and cross-region telemetry pipelines in a highly regulated environment.
- **SOAR Architecture & Security Automation Platform:** Designed and delivered an enterprise-wide SOAR platform automating alert enrichment, investigation, and response across XDR, cloud, and identity systems, eliminating over \$1M per year in analyst labor while enabling continuous 24/7 operations.
- **Enterprise Threat Modeling & Risk Framework:** Created the organization's threat modeling framework to systematically assess cloud workloads, enterprise applications, and emerging technologies against real-world attack vectors and business impact.
- **Cloud Native Observability Platform:** Architected a cloud-native security observability platform consolidating enterprise telemetry and replacing legacy SIEM tooling, reducing annual licensing costs from multiple millions to ~\$80K while improving correlation, retention, and investigative performance.
- **Enterprise Security Correlation Platform:** Led the multi-million-dollar deployment of a cross-environment security analytics platform that unified cloud, endpoint, network, and identity telemetry, delivering 24/7 automated correlation and dramatically reducing manual SOC triage.

Education

Bachelor of Science in Information Systems

San Diego State University

- **Academic Honors:** Dean's List
- **Cyber Defense Team**
- **Association of IT Professionals**

Certifications

Security Architecture & Incident Response

- CISSP (Projected Q4 2026)
- CompTIA SecurityX (formerly CASP+)
- GIAC Certified Forensic Analyst (GCFA)
- CompTIA CySA+

Cloud & Platform Security

- AWS Certified Security, Specialty
- AWS Certified Solutions Architect
- Microsoft Azure Security Engineer (AZ-500)

Security Operations

- TippingPoint Certified Professional (IPS/IDS)
- Tenable Scanning & Analysis
- Splunk Core Certified User
- Palo Alto Networks Certified Security Automation Engineer

Foundational Security

- CompTIA Security+

Technical Skills

Security Tools and Technologies

- **Security Platforms:** DFIR, SOAR, SIEM, XDR, EDR
- **Network Security:** IDS/IPS, NGFW, VPN, WAF
- **Tools:** Nmap, Wireshark, Metasploit, Postman
- **Identity Management:** Entra ID/Azure Active Directory, Okta, AWS IAM
- **Email Security:** Microsoft 365 (M365), Office 365 (O365), Barracuda
- **Threat Detection:** Yara, Sigma rules

Cloud and Virtualization

- **Cloud Platforms:** Amazon Web Services (AWS), Microsoft Azure, Google Cloud Platform (GCP)
- **Containerization:** Kubernetes, Docker, Podman
- **Virtualization Technologies:** VMware

Programming and Scripting

- **Languages:** Python, Bash, PowerShell
- **Web Development:** HTML, JavaScript, CSS
- **Query Languages:** SQL, Kusto Query Language (KQL), XQL
- **AI:** Claude Code, Ollama, AWS Bedrock, OpenAI Codex, LangGraph, LangChain

Operating Systems

- **Desktop and Server OS:** Windows, macOS, Red Hat Enterprise Linux, Unix, Ubuntu, CentOS
- **Security Distributions:** Kali Linux, Parrot OS

Frameworks and Standards

- **Security Frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK Framework, NIST 800 series, CMMC
- **Development Practices:** Infrastructure-as-Code (IaC), CI/CD pipelines, SAST, SBOM

Domains of Expertise

- Detection Engineering & Analytics
- Threat Modeling & Attack Path Analysis
- Incident Response & Digital Forensics
- Security Architecture & Design Review
- Security Operations Strategy
- Threat Intelligence & Adversary Emulation
- Vulnerability & Exposure Management
- Cloud & Identity Security Architecture
- SOAR & Automation Engineering
- Cyber Deception
- Infrastructure & Platform Security
- Identity & Access Governance
- Security Policy & Control Design
- Regulatory & Compliance Engineering (FedRAMP, NIST, CMMC)
- Leadership, Strategy & Cross-Team Execution

Additional Training and Achievements

- **SANS FOR508: Advanced Incident Response, Threat Hunting, and Digital Forensics**
Challenge Coin Winner
- **Mandiant Academy:** Linux Enterprise Incident Response
- **TryHackMe.com:** Ranked in the top 1%
- **Security Clearance:** US Citizen with an Active DoD Secret clearance, qualified for Top Secret/Sensitive Compartmented Information (TS/SCI)

Languages

- **English:** Fluent
- **Farsi/Persian:** Fluent
- **Spanish:** Elementary